
Native Languages, Level 5, Open (NL5)**(LNAEO–LNOEO)**

This course provides students with opportunities to increase their knowledge of a Native language and culture. Students will increase their vocabulary; use complex language patterns and formal language; and use the Native language to analyse literature, discuss issues (e.g., economic development, personal development), and study Native customs, traditions, and world views. They will examine differences in dialects while communicating with others electronically.

Prerequisite: Native Languages, Level 4, Open, or demonstrated proficiency

Oral Communication

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- communicate fluently;
- demonstrate an understanding of the concepts of citizenship and relationships (Aboriginal world view) in the context of an indigenous culture outside North America;
- demonstrate a basic understanding of formal and specialized language;
- understand and use complex language patterns.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of the way of life of an indigenous culture outside North America;
- interpret written and oral works with minimal assistance;
- explain how the meaning of words (e.g., *milk*) has changed over time;
- express a point of view on contemporary issues (e.g., environmental issues, political issues) from a Native perspective;
- identify dialects from other regions.

Use of Words and Language Patterns

By the end of this course, students will:

- use specialized language to explain traditional skills (e.g., planting and harvesting, snowsnake making, canoe making);
- use correct vocabulary in presentations;
- demonstrate an understanding of the language patterns used in speech by a Native elder;
- demonstrate an understanding of formal language used in ceremonies;
- use language as spoken by a fluent speaker;
- demonstrate an understanding of the concept of citizenship in an indigenous culture outside North America;
- demonstrate an understanding of the concept of relationships (Aboriginal world view) in an indigenous culture outside North America.

Reading

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate comprehension of written works;
- read a variety of written works to gather information about cultural perspectives;
- demonstrate an understanding of an Aboriginal world view through an analysis of words;
- use electronic technology to communicate in a Native language with other students.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate comprehension of written works by participating in and producing a language project (e.g., debating, creating dialogues);
- compare and contrast ideas, characters, and events in written works;
- read a variety of written works (e.g., legends, short stories, Native language newspapers) for different purposes;
- derive the meaning of new words from context.

Use of Words and Language Patterns

By the end of this course, students will:

- read materials orally, using correct pronunciation and with fluency;
- demonstrate an ability to analyse language patterns in a variety of written works;
- translate passages in written works;
- demonstrate an ability to read written works that contain specialized vocabulary;
- communicate in a Native language to exchange ideas and feelings on social issues (e.g., rural and urban lifestyles, substance abuse, the judicial system) with other students, using electronic technology.

Writing

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- use an expanded vocabulary and varied language patterns correctly and apply spelling strategies effectively;
- demonstrate an understanding of language conventions in their writing;
- produce a variety of written works, such as short essays, letters, narratives, transcriptions of legends and oral prose, and biographies;
- independently revise and edit their writing for accuracy of language use;
- use electronic technology to communicate in a Native language with other students.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate sensitivity to Native cultural values in their writing (e.g., in a short story, journal, essay, or article);
- demonstrate a knowledge of different forms of writing (e.g., description, exposition, report, argument, dialogue, narrative, transcription, biography);
- use familiar expressions accurately and experiment with complex forms to express facts (e.g., prepare a news broadcast for the local radio station);
- use a variety of paragraph structures to organize text and create story lines (e.g., a dialogue to accompany a drawing or photograph);
- demonstrate an awareness of the potential of words and phrases to have multiple meanings (e.g., literal and figurative meanings);
- communicate in a Native language with other students on contemporary issues (e.g., substance abuse, urbanization, health) using electronic technology.

Use of Words and Language Patterns

By the end of this course, students will:

- use language patterns correctly;
- demonstrate an understanding of the variety of sentence structures used in Native languages;
- use specialized vocabulary relating to familiar topics.

Grammar, Language Conventions, and Vocabulary

Languages reflect the culture and philosophy of the people who speak them. Grammar, which is the framework of language, reveals the ways in which each language defines relationships between concepts. An understanding of these relationships enhances a speaker's ability to formulate ideas, to communicate, and to understand the communication of others.

In Native languages, individual words carry a great deal of information, much more than is the case in English or French. Effective communication in Native languages, therefore, requires grammatical accuracy.

The learning of grammar can be a productive and enjoyable activity for students. It is not necessary for students to memorize rules of grammar. A knowledge of the structure of a language allows students to analyse and reflect on its use, thereby stimulating their interest in language itself, deepening their understanding of the language being learned, and helping them to develop their writing skills and to analyse the writing of others.

This section supports all three strands in the course. Students should develop and apply the language knowledge through communicative activities in all three strands.

Language elements for the two Native language families in Ontario, Algonquian and Iroquoian, differ and are therefore listed separately.

Sentence Structure

In Native languages, sentences are structured in a variety of ways that may include one or more of the following parts of speech: verbs, nouns, pronouns, particles, and conjunctions.

A verb and its affixes, used to convey such grammatical information as person, number, and tense, can represent a complete sentence. Sometimes a particle can express a complete thought. Sentences may also consist of one or more clauses that in English would be parallel to simple, compound, complex, or compound-complex constructions.

Spelling Strategies

Use of:

- cluster and syllable recognition
- capitalization
- punctuation
- diacritical marks
- contractions as they occur in rapid speech (Iroquoian)
- resources to confirm spelling (e.g., classroom-displayed lists, texts, dictionaries, lexicons, information technology)

Vocabulary

Use of:

- basic vocabulary (*sample list*: numbers from 1 to 1 000 000 plus; mathematical operations; kinship as it applies to cosmology; seasonal activities; social events; weather; community activities; government; the arts – music, film, dance, theatre, painting; formal oratory)
- new words from units of study and personal and class word lists
- a Native-English dictionary or lexicon to build vocabulary

Language Elements

Algonquian Language Family

Verbs

- *Type*
 - animate intransitive
 - inanimate intransitive
 - animate transitive
 - inanimate transitive
- *Tense*
 - present
 - simple past
 - intentional future
 - definite future
 - changed-form conjunct
 - dual
 - conjunct suffix
- *Person*
 - first, second, third
 - regular, irregular
 - proximate
 - obviative
 - animate intransitive
 - inanimate intransitive
 - animate transitive
 - inanimate transitive
- *Number*
 - singular
 - plural
- *Order*
 - imperative
 - simple direct commands
 - delayed
 - independent
 - simple statements
 - conjunct
 - interrogative
 - compound sentences
 - complex sentences
 - compound-complex sentences
 - conditional sentences
 - dubitative

Nouns

- *Negation*
 - yes/no questions
 - simple negation
 - prohibition
- *Voice*
 - active
 - passive
- *Type*
 - locative
 - diminutive
 - possessive
 - dependent
 - pejorative
 - vocative
 - preterit
- *Gender*
 - animate
 - inanimate
- *Case*
 - subject
 - object
- *Number*
 - singular
 - plural
- *Person*
 - third
 - proximate
 - obviative

Pronouns

- *Type*
 - personal
 - dependent
 - independent
 - interrogative
 - demonstrative
 - possessive
 - indefinite
 - reflexive
 - dubitative
 - pausal
- *Number*
 - singular
 - plural
- *Person*
 - first, second, third
 - proximate
 - obviative

Particles

- *Type*
 - question particles
 - conjunctions
 - quantifiers
 - adverbs indicating time, place, manner, degree

Language Elements

Iroquoian Language Family

Verbs

- *Classification*
 - subjective
 - stem classifications
 - objective
 - stem classifications
 - transitive
 - intransitive
 - irregular
- *Conjugations*
 - pronouns
 - first, second, third person
 - personal
 - singular
 - dual
 - plural
 - tense and aspect
 - imperatives
 - interactives
- *Incorporation*
 - prefixes, infixes, suffixes
 - with noun
 - in adjectival construction
 - in quantitative construction
 - pre-pronominal prefixes
 - cislocative
 - translocative
 - pre-pronominal prefix combinations
 - *te-* verbs (Mohawk)
 - *de-* verbs (Cayuga)
 - negation
 - contrastive construction
- *Irregular verbs*

Nouns

- *Classification*
 - formal
 - functional
 - animate
 - inanimate
- *Independent possessives*
 - singular, dual, plural
 - use with locatives
 - use to indicate kinship
- *Independent pronouns*
- *Independent numeration*
- *Independent locatives*
- *Independent adjectives*
- *Incorporation*
 - numeration
 - possessives
 - with a verb
 - in adjectival construction
 - pluralizers
 - locatives
 - quantitatives
 - qualitatives
 - incorporation combinations

Sentences

- *Types*
 - simple
 - compound
 - complex
 - compound-complex
- *Gender agreement*
- *Creation of negatives*
- *Creation of questions*
- *Creation of comparatives*
- *Independent quantity statements*
- *Adverbial phrases*

Particles

- *Types*
 - question particles
 - conjunctions
 - quantifiers
 - adverbs indicating time, place, manner, degree